

THE BODY REMEMBERS

5 daily rituals to return to your embodied intelligence and reclaim the self you buried under the noise

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YOU MOVE THROUGH YOUR DAYS MENTALLY CAPABLE, SOCIALLY FUNCTIONAL, AND QUIETLY HOLLOW. SOMETHING IN YOU IS ALWAYS SLIGHTLY ELSEWHERE. THE BODY SPEAKS AND YOU OVERRIDE IT WITH LOGIC. THE BREATH STAYS SHALLOW. THE HEART SIGNALS WHAT IT NEEDS AND THE MIND FINDS A REASON TO DISMISS IT.

THIS IS NOT A PERSONAL FAILING. IT IS WHAT HAPPENS WHEN WE LIVE FROM THE NECK UP IN A WORLD THAT REWARDS IT. THESE FIVE PRACTICES ARE NOT A WELLNESS ROUTINE. THEY ARE A DOORWAY BACK. SHORT ENOUGH TO DO DAILY. DEEP ENOUGH TO CHANGE WHAT YOU HEAR WHEN YOU GO QUIET.

PRACTICE ONE

ARRIVE — THE THREE-BREATH RESET

Most people never fully arrive in their body because they never consciously cross the threshold between outer world and inner world. The Three-Breath Reset is a micro-ritual that does exactly that. It takes ninety seconds and it works because it interrupts the automatic nervous system pattern of perpetual readiness.

How to do it:

— Sit or stand wherever you are. Close your eyes if it is safe to do so.

- First breath: inhale for four counts, exhale for six. You are signaling safety to your nervous system.
- Second breath: feel the weight of your body — buttocks on chair, feet on floor, hands resting. Name three points of contact aloud or internally.
- Third breath: place one hand on your sternum. Feel the warmth. Notice what is here, not what needs to be solved.
- Open your eyes. You have arrived.

Use this at the start of the morning, before any significant conversation, and before entering any sacred or ceremonial space.

DO THIS

Set a phone alarm for 7am labelled "Arrive." Do the Three-Breath Reset before you look at any screen. Do it for seven days and notice what changes in the quality of your first hour.

PRACTICE TWO

ROOT — THE FIVE-MINUTE EARTH RITUAL

02

The body disconnects when it does not feel safe. Safety in the nervous system is not conceptual. It is felt through sensation: heaviness, warmth, pressure, the reliable pull of gravity. Grounding is not a metaphor here. It is a physiological recalibration.

The practice:

- Barefoot if possible. Stand outside or on an uncarpeted floor.
- Bend your knees slightly. Feel the slight yield. This is your body accepting support.
- Press through all four corners of each foot: big toe mound, little toe mound, inner heel, outer heel.
- Imagine roots growing downward — not as fantasy, but as an invitation for your weight to drop fully.
- Breathe into your belly, not your chest. Stay here for five minutes. Notice any resistance. That resistance is information.

If you practice any form of ceremonial or tantrik work, do this before you enter the space. It anchors you below the mental chatter and opens the channel for genuine presence.

PRACTICE THREE

LISTEN — THE PLEASURE INVENTORY

03

Many people have been taught — explicitly or by omission — that pleasure is frivolous, dangerous, or selfish. The sacred feminine traditions understand pleasure as intelligence: a direct signal from the body about what is life-giving and what is not. Reclaiming it is not indulgence. It is a return to an ancient guidance system.

The Pleasure Inventory is a daily two-minute practice. Keep a small notebook or a note on your phone:

- Name one sensory experience that felt genuinely good today. Sunlight on skin. The texture of your morning cup. The sound of rain. The feeling after movement.
- Name one emotional experience that felt right, even briefly. Being seen. Saying something true. A moment of genuine laughter.
- Name one thing your body is asking for right now. Not what your schedule allows. What your body is asking for.

You are not performing gratitude. You are training attention. Where attention goes, aliveness follows.

DO THIS

Tonight before sleep, write three entries in your Pleasure Inventory. Do not filter for whether they are "significant enough." The body does not rank its wisdom. Neither should you.

PRACTICE FOUR

RELEASE — THE SOMATIC SHAKE

04

Animals release stress through involuntary shaking. Humans learned to suppress it. What the body could not shake out, it stored. The somatic shake is one of the most direct tools for moving what has been held — it works through the body's own tremor mechanism and requires no particular skill or spiritual vocabulary.

How to practice:

- Stand with feet hip-width apart, knees soft. Begin to gently bounce through the knees.
- Let the bounce travel upward. Let the belly soften. Let the arms hang loose and begin to vibrate with the movement.
- If sound wants to come — a hum, a sigh, a tone — let it. Sound is vibration. It accelerates release.
- Continue for five to ten minutes. The key quality is surrender: you are not performing shaking, you are allowing it.
- Finish by returning to stillness. Stand quietly for two minutes. Notice what has shifted.

This practice is particularly useful before integration sessions, after kambo or plant medicine work, or on any day where you notice yourself holding tension without knowing why.

PRACTICE FIVE

INTEGRATE — THE EVENING BODY SCAN

05

Integration is where the real work happens. Not in the ceremony. Not in the peak moment. In the ordinary evening, when you choose to sit with what moved through you rather than consuming something to avoid it. This five-minute body scan closes the day consciously and builds the habit of listening inward.

The practice:

- Lie down. Close your eyes. Begin at the top of your head and move your attention slowly downward.
- At each area — skull, jaw, throat, chest, belly, hips, legs, feet — simply notice. Temperature. Tension. Sensation. Numbness is also information.
- When you find an area holding something, breathe into it. Do not try to fix or explain. Just acknowledge: "I feel this here."
- Before sleep, ask your body one question: "What does this day want me to know?" Wait quietly. What comes first, before the mind edits it, is often the truest answer.

DO THIS

Do the Evening Body Scan tonight. Set a seven-minute timer. Afterwards, write one sentence — whatever arose first. Keep it. Read it in the morning. Notice if anything has clarified by then.

READY TO GO DEEPER THAN A DAILY PRACTICE?

These five rituals are the foundation. The real work happens in circle, in ceremony, and in devoted containers that hold you accountable to the full truth of who you are. Medicine Within offers tantrik temples, sacred feminine embodiment, and one-to-one integration — in Amsterdam and beyond.

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